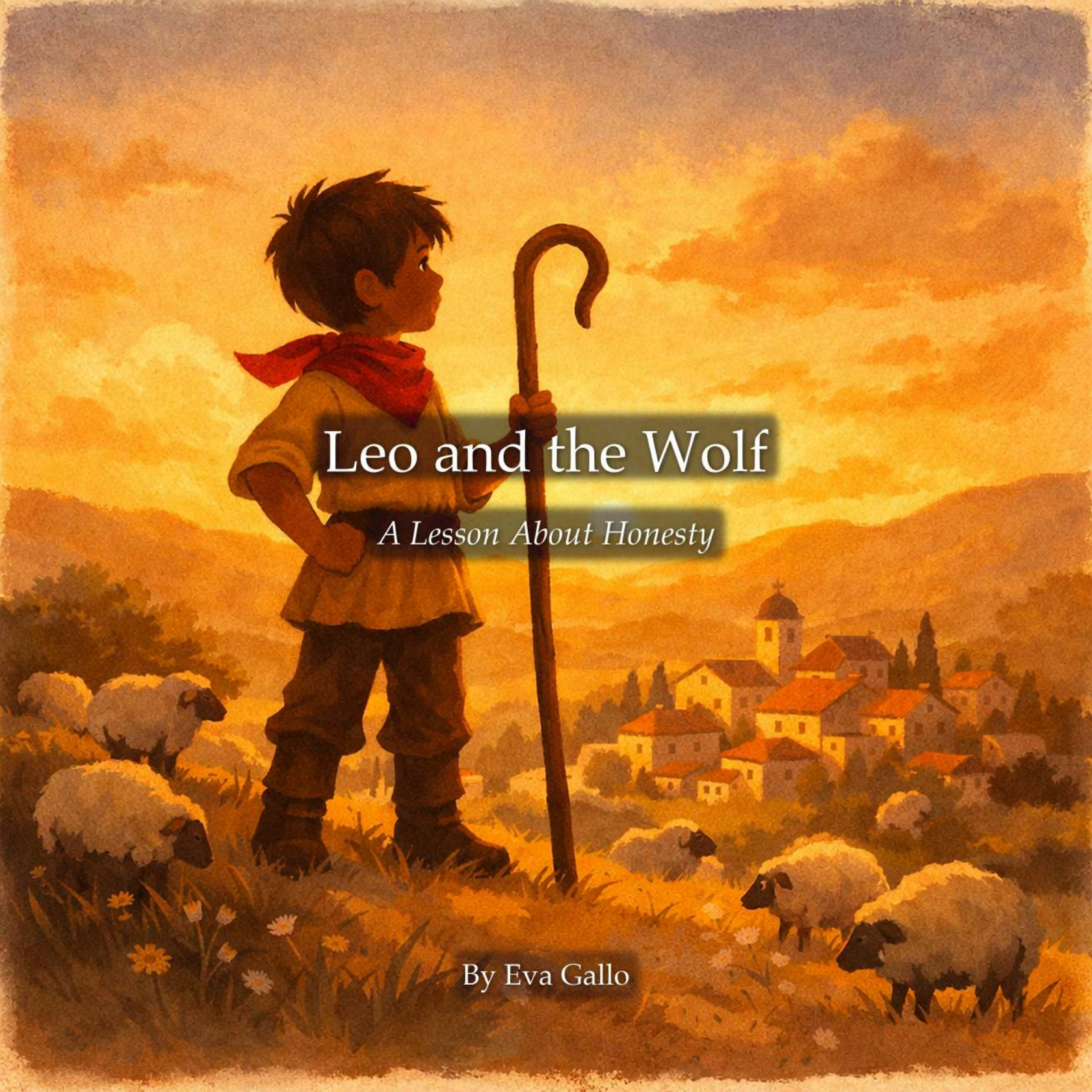


A young boy with dark hair, wearing a red scarf and a light-colored tunic, stands on a grassy hill. He holds a long, curved wooden staff in his right hand and looks out over a village in the distance. The village features several houses with red-tiled roofs and a church with a dome. The scene is set against a warm, golden sunset sky with soft clouds. Several sheep are grazing on the hill in the foreground.

Leo and the Wolf

A Lesson About Honesty

By Eva Gallo



Leo and the Wolf: A Lesson About Honesty
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First edition.

For every child who is learning that words matter, and that it is never too late to tell the truth.



The morning Leo's parents handed him the shepherd's crook, he stood a little taller.



"Be careful," said his mother.
"And always tell the truth," said his father.



At first, Leo loved the job. But hours passed.



The sheep only ate. He watched. He waited. He had an idea.



"WOLF! WOLF!" Leo shouted. "HELP!"
The villagers came running, pitchforks, brooms, and all.



But there was no wolf.
Just Leo, laughing until his sides hurt.



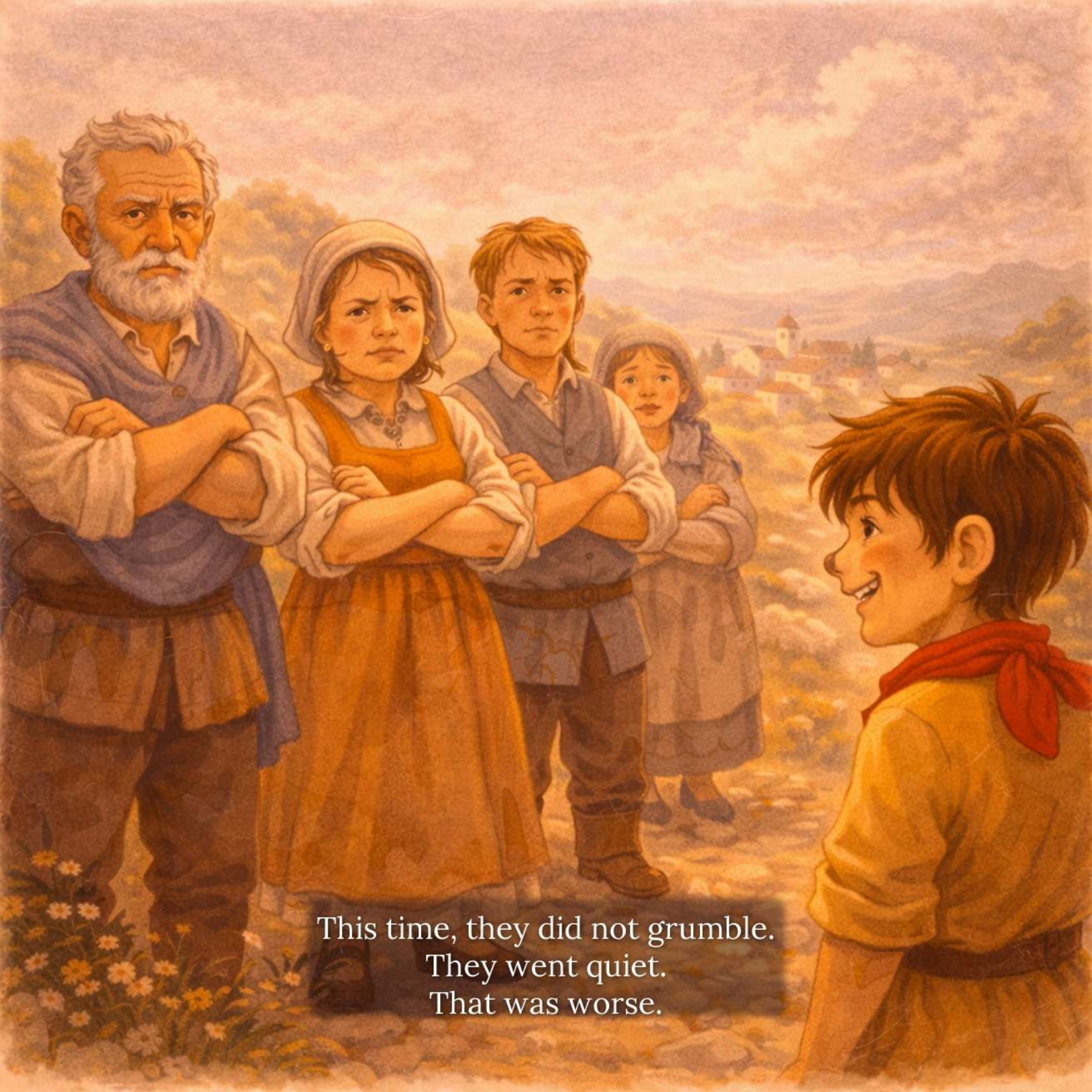
"Never cry wolf unless it's true," said the elder.
Leo nodded.



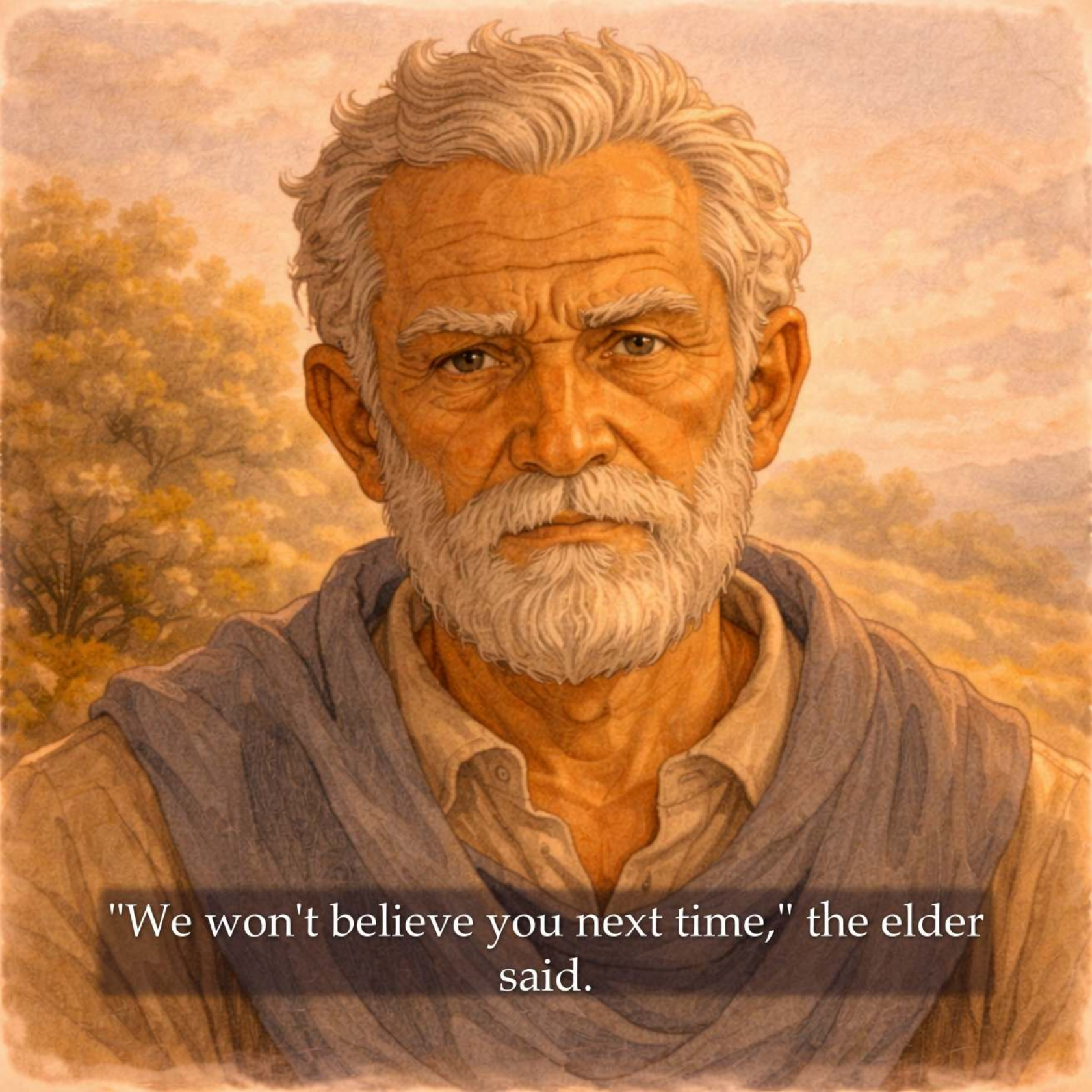
He smiled when the elder wasn't looking.
He had already forgotten.



The next week, Leo shouted again.
"WOLF! WOLF!"
The villagers came. They found nothing.



This time, they did not grumble.
They went quiet.
That was worse.



"We won't believe you next time," the elder
said.



The villagers walked away.
Leo watched them go.



The sun was dropping. The sheep were settling.



At the edge of the forest, something moved.

Then Leo saw it.





Yellow eyes. Teeth. A real wolf.



"WOLF! PLEASE!"



The village stayed dark.
No one came.



Leo's hands shook. But the sheep needed him.
He took a breath.



He stepped between the wolf and his flock.



Leo yelled. He stomped. He waved his crook and made himself as big as he could.



The wolf backed away.



Three sheep were gone.



Leo sat in the grass and did not laugh.
The moon was very bright.

His parents found him at dawn.



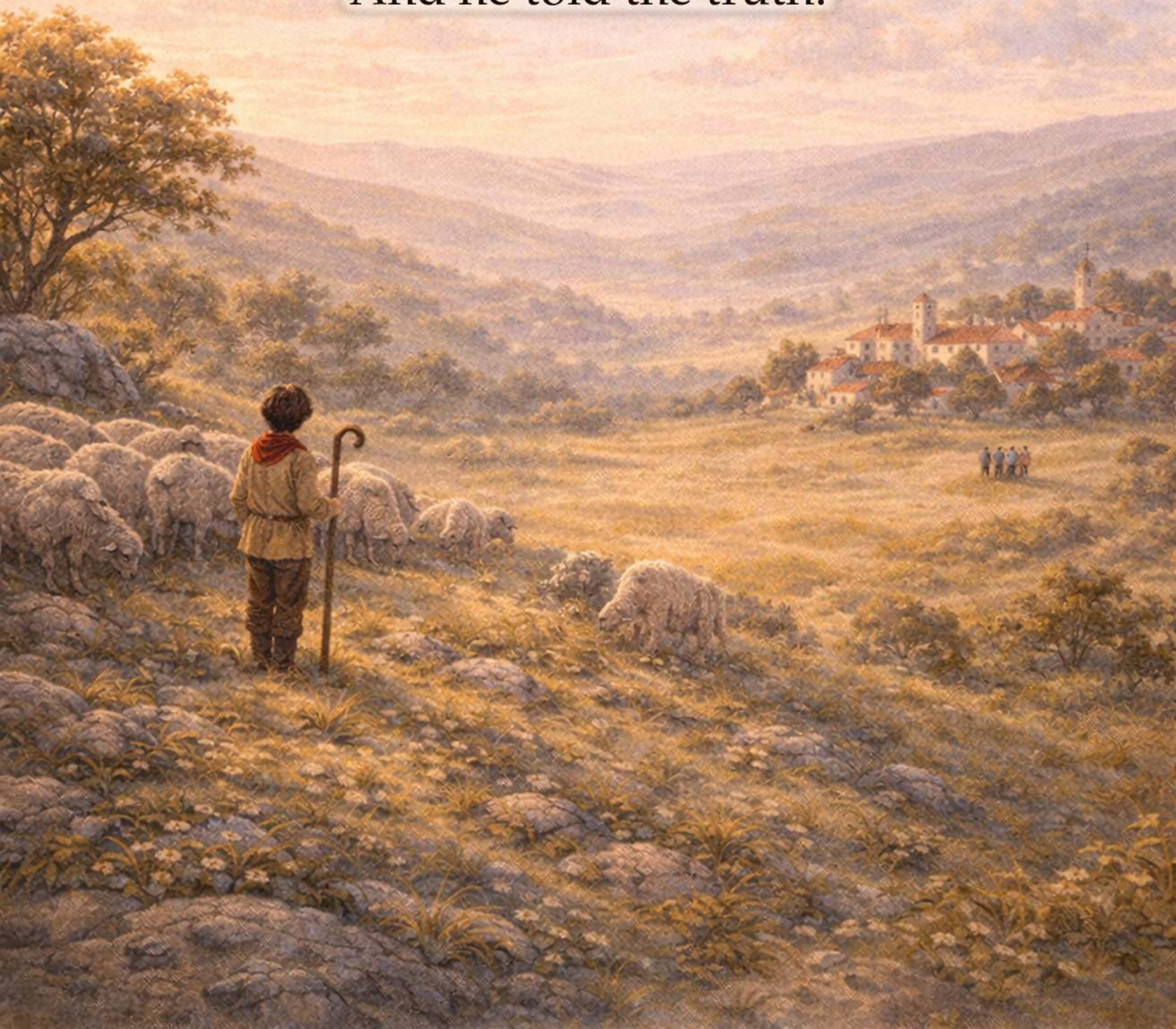


"When you lie," said his father quietly, "people stop trusting you.
Even when you tell the truth."



Leo went back to the hillside.
He worked. He watched. He waited.

And he told the truth.



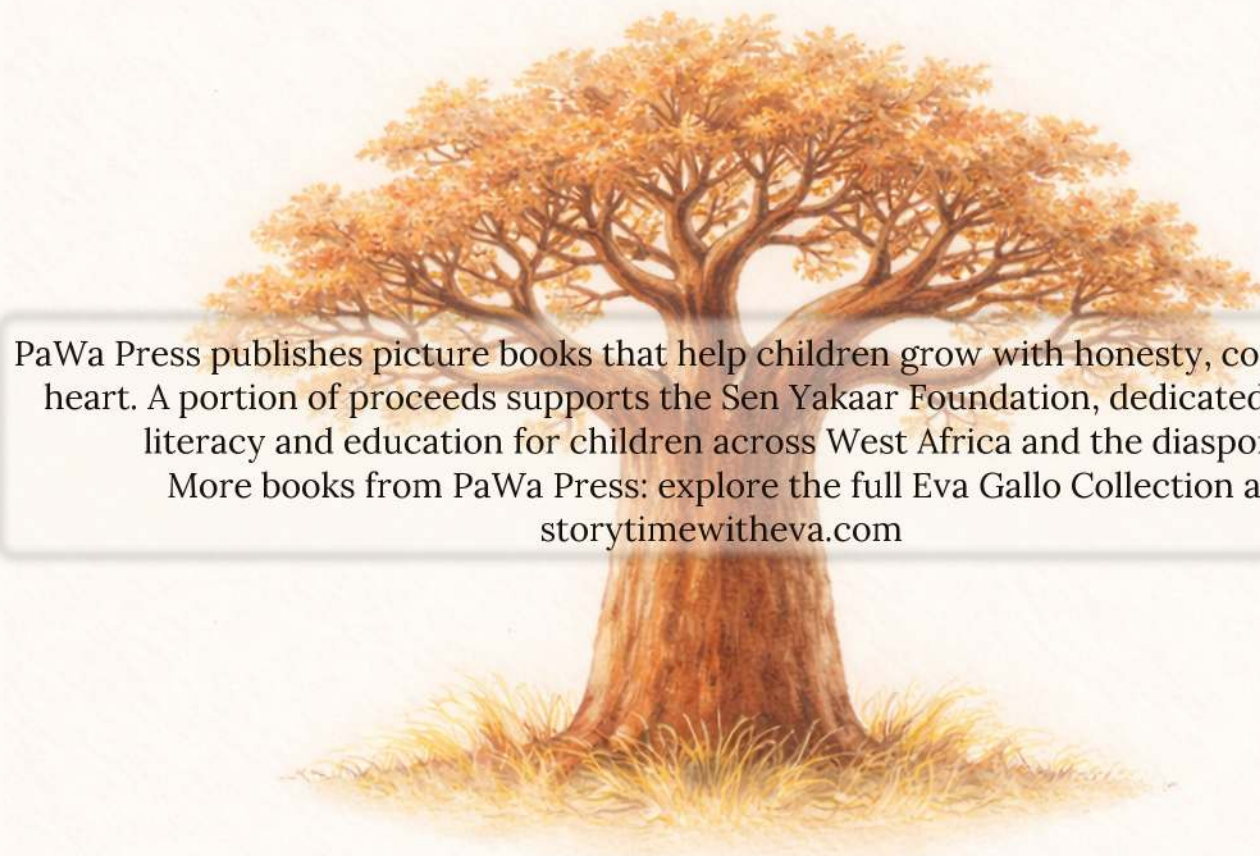


About the Author:

Eva Gallo is a children's book author whose stories explore honesty, courage, and the quiet lessons that shape who we become. *Leo and the Wolf* is a PaWa Press standalone title. Learn more at storytimewiththeva.com.

Five Questions to Ask Together:

1. Why did the villagers run the first time Leo called for help?
2. How would you feel if a friend tricked you the same way twice?
3. When the real wolf came, why didn't anyone help Leo?
4. Leo is back on the hillside at the end, but things aren't the same yet. What does he need to do?
5. Can you think of a time you had to tell a hard truth?



PaWa Press publishes picture books that help children grow with honesty, courage, and heart. A portion of proceeds supports the Sen Yakaar Foundation, dedicated to early literacy and education for children across West Africa and the diaspora.

More books from PaWa Press: explore the full Eva Gallo Collection at storytimewitheva.com